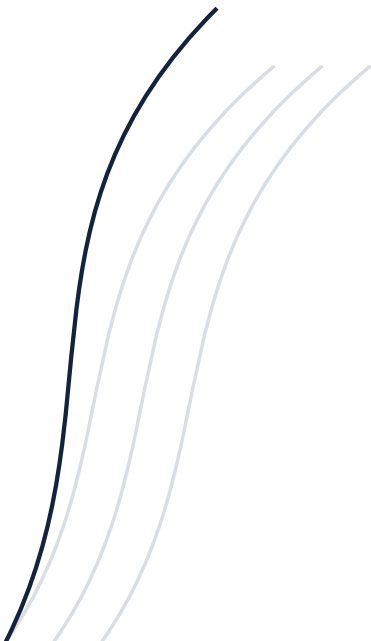




Deferral Management System

User Guide



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1-Introduction

The Deferral Management System (DMS) is a company-wide tool designed to make the process of requesting, reviewing, and approving Last Acceptable Failure Date (LAFD) deferrals simple, transparent, and auditable. Engineers can submit a deferral request with the supporting risk assessment and mitigations, and then track it as it moves through a structured, multi-step approval cycle. Approvers sign each step digitally, add comments, and return or reject a request when it needs correction.

Once submitted, a deferral is stored in a central database and automatically routed to the correct approvers based on department and decision points made along the way (for example, whether Technical Authority or AD HOC review is required). Every approval, return, and rejection is stamped with the approver's digital signature and kept in the deferral's history, and the completed record can be exported as a PDF for audit and reporting.

The application also sends notifications — inside the app and, once enabled, as native browser notifications — so approvers know immediately when a deferral needs their action, and so initiators are reminded before a new LAFD date arrives.

2-Accessing the App

Users can access the DMS through the following method:

2.1 Direct Link

- The application can be launched directly using the provided URL.
- [DMS APPLICATION LINK]

2.2 User Authentication (Create Account & Sign In)

New users create their own account the first time they use the app; there is no need to wait for an administrator to set one up before signing in for the first time.

Create an account — steps:

- 1 Open the sign-up page from the sign-in screen (the “Create account” link), or the address shared by your administrator.
- 2 Enter your full name, work email address, and a password.
- 3 Choose your Department from the dropdown. This decides which Department Head reviews deferrals you create.
- 4 Enter your Position (job title).
- 5 Press **Create account**. You will be signed in automatically.
- 6 An administrator will confirm your role (Applicant, Department Head, Reliability Engineer, etc.) from the Admin page.



SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Sign-up form — name, email, password, department and position fields, filled in.

save the real image as: public/user-guide/create-account.png

Sign in — steps:

- 1 Open the sign-in page and enter your email address and password.
- 2 Press **Sign in**. You will land on the Dashboard.
- 3 On a new browser, the app may ask permission to show notifications — choose **Allow** so you are alerted when a deferral needs your action, even when the tab is not open.



3-Application Main Screens

3.1 Dashboard Overview

The Dashboard summarizes deferrals by department, status, and deferral rank (1st, 2nd, or 3rd deferral for the same work order). Initiators and Department Heads see counts for their own department; higher management roles see all departments. Active records (Draft, In Approval, Returned, Approved) and history records (Completed, Closed, Rejected, Deleted, Expired) are shown separately.

3.2 Features

The application provides a complete set of features for creating, tracking, approving, and reporting on deferrals, organized into a small number of screens.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Annotated main screen — label each control: Deferrals list, New deferral, Search, Filters, Notifications bell, Profile menu, Approve/Return/Reject panel.

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3.2.1 Create an Account

See section 2.2 above for the full sign-up steps and screenshot.

3.2.2 Add Your Signature

Every user uploads a personal signature once. From then on, it is stamped automatically on every approval, return, or rejection they perform, and on any deferral PDF that includes their sign-off.

- 1 Open **Profile** from the sidebar or the user menu in the header.
- 2 In the Signature section, press **Upload & Trim** and choose an image of your signature.
- 3 Use the editor to crop tightly, then adjust rotation, brightness, and contrast.
- 4 Press **Save**. Repeat any time to replace the signature with a new one.



SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Profile page — signature upload and trim editor, mid-crop.
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3.2.3 Create a New Deferral

- 1 Open **Deferrals**, then choose the new deferral action.
- 2 Enter the Work Order number and title. If the work order already has a deferral, the app warns the initiator so a second/third deferral is intentional.
- 3 Complete equipment information, task criticality, and safety criticality.
- 4 Enter Original LAFD, Current LAFD, and Deferred To (New LAFD) — the new date must be later than the current one and within the 6-month maximum.
- 5 Complete the RAM risk assessment for People, Asset, Environment, and Reputation.
- 6 Add one or more mitigations, each with a required department — that department's head is added to the approval cycle.
- 7 Upload supporting attachments (PDF, PNG, JPG, WEBP, up to 25 MB each).
- 8 Save, then **Submit**. Missing required fields are listed before submission is allowed.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

New deferral form — work order, equipment and LAFD date fields.
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3.2.4 Search, Filters & Export

- Filter by department, status, deferral code, work order number, equipment tag, updated date range, and 1st/2nd/3rd deferral rank.
- Initiators are limited to searching within their own department.
- Results are ordered by last update, newest first, loading more as you scroll.
- **Export CSV** downloads the deferrals matching the current filters — apply filters first.

3.2.5 Approve / Return / Reject a Deferral

A reviewer is any approval user with an active approval step — Department Head, Reliability Engineer, Reliability GM, Technical Authority, AD HOC, Responsible GM, SOD, DFGM, or Planning.

- 1 Open **Approvals** from the sidebar, or open the deferral from a notification.
- 2 Review the Details tab: work order, equipment, LAFD dates, risk assessment, mitigations, and attachments.
- 3 Review the Approvals tab for the current stage, comments, and signatures.
- 4 If you are the active approver, use the action panel: **Approve**, **Return to Initiator**, or **Reject Completely**. A comment is required for a return or a rejection.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Approval action panel — comment box and Approve / Return / Reject buttons.

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3.2.6 Reliability GM Decision (Technical Authority / AD HOC)

Before signing the Reliability GM approval step, the Reliability GM can add optional Technical Authority and/or AD HOC approval steps to the workflow, then press **Save Decision**. The panel is editable only while that step is active and pending.

3.2.7 Notifications

- Approvers are notified when a deferral needs their action; initiators are notified on return, rejection, completion, and expiry.
- Reliability Engineer, Reliability GM, and the initiator receive expiry reminders ahead of the new LAFD date.
- When browser notifications are enabled, the same events also trigger a native browser alert, even if the DMS tab is not open.



3.2.8 PDF Export & Signatures

- The Print tab exports a PDF with the full deferral, risk data, mitigations, approval timeline, and signatures.
- Mitigation approvals appear in their own PDF table: department, mitigation, signature, approver, date, and comment.



4-Approval Cycle & Roles

A deferral moves through the following roles in order. Each role signs, returns, or rejects the step that is active for them.

Step	Role	Responsibility
1	Department Head	of the initiator's department — first review of every deferral.
2	Mitigation Department Heads	one per mitigation department selected on the deferral, in parallel.
3	Reliability Engineer	reviews after department/mitigation approvals are complete.
4	Reliability GM	reviews next, and decides whether Technical Authority and/or AD HOC are required.
5	Technical Authority / AD HOC	only inserted when the Reliability GM enables them.
6	Parallel Sign-off Group	Responsible GM (always), plus SOD and DFGM in parallel for a 2nd/3rd deferral.
7	Planning Engineer	GMS integration sign-off.
8	Planning Supervisor Engineer	final signature — the deferral becomes Completed.

At every step the approver can **Approve** (moves to the next step), **Return to Initiator** (sends it back for correction; the initiator can resubmit), or **Reject Completely** (ends the workflow — the same record cannot be resubmitted).



5-Deferral Statuses

Status	Meaning	Next Action
Draft	Being prepared by the initiator; not yet in approval.	Complete required fields and submit, or delete.
In Approval	Moving through the approval cycle.	The active approver reviews and decides.
Returned	Sent back by an approver for correction.	Initiator edits and resubmits.
Rejected	Stopped permanently by an approver.	Cannot be resubmitted; create a new record if still needed.
Approved	All approvals before Planning are complete.	Awaiting the two Planning signatures.
Completed	All approvals, including Planning, are signed.	Initiator can close once the job is executed.
Closed	Confirmed executed and closed by the initiator.	Kept for history, reporting, and PDF export.
Expired	The new LAFD date passed while still active.	Create a 2nd/3rd deferral, or close if completed.



6-Statistics & Dashboard Screen

The Dashboard provides a visual overview of deferrals across the company, helping users and management quickly understand distribution and progress.

6.1 Department Breakdown

- Department tabs show how many deferrals are in each status.
- The app normalizes department names so capitalization differences do not create duplicate departments.

6.2 Deferral Rank

- Counters show whether a record is the 1st, 2nd, or 3rd deferral created for the same work order.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Dashboard — department/status breakdown and deferral-rank counters.

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